

Los Angeles Regional Water Quality Control Board

September 3, 2015

Phil Friess
Joint Outfall System
1955 Workman Mill Road
Whittier, CA 90601

Dear Mr. Friess,

MINOR MODIFICATIONS AND CLARIFICATIONS TO THE SANTA CLARITA VALLEY SANITATION DISTRICTS (SCVSD) WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS FOR:

- SAUGUS WATER RECLAMATION PLANT (WRP), ORDER R4-2015-0072 (NPDES NO. CA0054313) AND
- VALENCIA WRP ORDER R4-2015-0071 (NPDES NO. CA0054216)

In reviewing Waste Discharge Requirements (WDR) Orders R4-2015-0072 for the Saugus WRP and R4-2015-0071 for the Valencia WRP, needed clarifications have been identified by SCVSD and raised to the attention of the Los Angeles Regional Water Quality Control Board (Regional Water Board) staff. SCVSD requests that the January 20, 2016 interim compliance date be modified by one month to February 20, 2016, and that several descriptions in the NPDES permits be adjusted to reflect the path to compliance now being pursued by SCVSD. However, the final compliance date for chloride will not change.

Pursuant to Code of Federal Regulations, 40 CFR Section 122.63(c), minor modification of permits are allowed to change an interim compliance date in a schedule of compliance, provided the new date is not more than 120 days after the date specified in the existing permit and does not interfere with attainment of the final compliance date requirement. Therefore, this letter serves as notification that the following minor modifications are made to WDR Orders R4-2015-0071 and R4-2015-0072 (additions are in underlined and deletions are in ~~strikeout~~ format):

1. In Order R4-2015-0071, Table 6 on page 25 of WDR; Table F- 11 on Page F-59 of the Fact Sheet; and, Section II on page J-5 of Attachment J, the following changes are made:

Table 6. Compliance Schedule & Milestone Dates

Project & Sub-tasks*	Implement- ation Deadlines	9 month deliverable Schedule					
		4/1/15 to 12/31/15	1/1/16 to 9/30/16	10/1/16 to 6/30/17	7/1/17 to 3/30/18	4/1/18 to 12/31/18	1/1/19 to 9/30/19
Deep Well Injection Test Well/ <u>Alternate Brine Management</u>							
• Complete Design <u>Deep Well Injection Test Well</u>	9/30/2015	X					
• Award Contract <u>Release Draft SEIR for Public Review</u>	4/20/2016 <u>2/20/2016</u>		X				
• Construction and Testing <u>Approve/Certify Final SEIR</u>	11/8/2016			X			

CHARLES STRINGER, CHAIR | SAMUEL UNGER, EXECUTIVE OFFICER

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Project & Sub-tasks*	Implement- ation Deadlines	9 month deliverable Schedule					
		4/1/15 to 12/31/15	1/1/16 to 9/30/16	10/1/16 to 6/30/17	7/1/17 to 3/30/18	4/1/18 to 12/31/18	1/1/19 to 9/30/19
UV Disinfection Facilities at Valencia and Saugus WRPs							
• Complete Design	4/12/2017			X			
• Award Contract	7/10/2017				X		
• Start Onsite Construction	3/10/2018				X		
• Startup	7/1/2019						X
MF/RO and Brine Minimization <u>Advanced Treatment</u> Facilities							
• Complete Design	4/12/2017			X			
• Award Contract	7/10/2017				X		
• Start Onsite Construction	3/10/2018				X		
• Startup	7/1/2019						X
Final Deep Well Injection Production Wells <u>Brine Construction</u> Facilities							
• Complete Design	6/6/2017			X			
• Start Onsite Construction	12/29/2018					X	
• Startup	7/1/2019						X
Brine Force Main and Pump Station <u>Management</u>							
• Complete 50% Design	11/6/2017				X		
• Complete Design	5/6/2018					X	
• Startup	7/1/2019						X

- * The Regional Water Board acknowledges that on March 11, 2015 the SCVSD Board directed its staff to withdraw the proposed location for a deep injection well site identified in the TMDL from consideration within the Supplemental EIR and to evaluate alternative site locations. As a result, SCVSD may not be able to complete Task 4aⁱⁱ and Task 4aⁱⁱⁱ specifically as they appear in Resolution R4-20 14-010, but intends to consider and implement an alternative for disposal of brine in sufficient time to achieve compliance by July 1, 2019.

2. In Order R4-2015-0071, for the Valencia WRP, Section II.E of the Fact Sheet on page F-14, delete reference to deep well injection:

E. Planned Changes

The Valencia WRP's treatment system had been upgraded in the past to nitrify and de-nitrify the effluent for ammonia-nitrogen and nitrate-nitrogen removal. Major plant upgrades are proposed by the Permittee for the Valencia WRP to achieve compliance with the *Upper Santa Clara River Chloride TMDL*. SCVSD proposes to implement the EIR alternative which includes construction of ultra violet (UV) disinfection facilities and membrane filtration/reverse osmosis (MF/RO) facilities with brine disposal ~~via deep well injection (DWI)~~ in order to attain the chloride numeric target in Reach 5 of the Santa Clara River, downstream of the Valencia WRP.

3. In Order R4-2015-0072, for the Saugus WRP, Section II.E of the Fact Sheet on page F-13, delete reference to deep well injection:

E. Planned Changes

The Saugus WRP's treatment system had been upgraded in the past to nitrify and denitrify the effluent for ammonia-nitrogen and nitrate-nitrogen removal. Major plant upgrades are proposed by the Permittee for the Saugus WRP to achieve compliance with the Upper Santa Clara River Chloride TMDL. SCVSD proposes to implement the EIR alternative which includes construction of UV disinfection facilities at both the Saugus and Valencia WRPs, coupled with membrane filtration/reverse osmosis (MF/RO) facilities and brine disposal ~~via deep well injection (DWI)~~ at the Valencia WRP. These facilities are necessary to attain the chloride numeric target in Reach 5 of the Santa Clara River, downstream of the WRPs.

If you have any questions, please contact Veronica Cuevas at (213) 576-6662 or Cris Morris at (213) 620-2083.

Sincerely,



Samuel Unger, P.E.
Executive Officer

cc: U. S. Environmental Protection Agency, Region 9, Permits Branch (WTR-5)
U. S. Army Corps of Engineers
NOAA, National Marine Fisheries Service
Department of Interior, U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service
Department of Fish and Wildlife, Region 5
State Water Resources Control Board, Office of Chief Counsel, Frances McChesney
State Water Resources Control Board (SWRCB), Division of Drinking Water
Los Angeles Department of Public Works
Heal the Bay
Los Angeles Waterkeeper (formerly Santa Monica Baykeeper)
Natural Resources Defense Council
Environment Now
California Coastal Commission, So. Coast Region
Ventura Coast Keeper
Wishtoyo
Ventura County
United Water Conservation District
Mr. Keith W. Pritsker, Law Office of Keith W. Pritsker
Mr. Mike Solomon, United Water Conservation District
Mr. John Yoon
Ms. Anne Marie Whalley
Mr. Jae Kim, Tetra Tech
Ms. Kristy Allen, Tetra Tech